

Android versus iOS

Is Android a better platform to develop games on or is iOS more lucrative?

Industry leaders feel that Android and iOS offer different benefits. Android is an open source platform and has an excellent API available for app development. iOS also has similar features. “Both mobile OS providers are maintaining marketplaces where people can easily add their apps and market them to millions of end users. Both providers have brought out excellent IDEs for app development. When it comes to user experience, iOS is rated a bit higher than Android. In the mobile domain, Android is more popular than iOS, but in the tablet industry, iOS is the dominant player,” shares Illyas.

Pradeep feels that at the end of the day, both are similar. Because today’s developer community is looking for multi-platform development instead of developing a game entirely on a single framework.

“Such games are called hybrid games. This hybrid model of games development uses HTML5 technology to the maximum level, and there are options to make use of the native frameworks to convert such games to any kind of platform instantly, via some process. In fact, of late, nearly 80 per cent of the developers are now getting converted, or rather, companies are shifting major manpower into HTML5-based technologies from native platforms. Though the Android and iOS platforms play a significant role in the market, HTML5 can fulfill many requirements. The native frameworks can take care of post-development work after the key logic is developed using HTML5. So this is the time for developing hybrid environments, not only for games, but even for mobile apps or the Web. Companies like TCS have already started implementing such methodologies,” says Pradeep.

‘Small is big’ in games development

Is there room for solo developers and small teams to make great games? “If the game has the ingredients to attract users, there is definitely a possibility. For a corporation, getting users is easier because it can spend a lot on promoting its games, by giving freebies, etc, whereas an indie developer cannot afford that. So in most of the cases, indie games result in few downloads when compared to games made by corporate houses. So there is always a possibility that individuals or small teams can create great games. Whether people get to know about them, or whether they can persuade people to install and play the game is a different story,” opines Swagata.

Indian developers should have a long-term vision and the patience to design, develop and then market an idea rather than just try to work on outsourced projects from clients/companies. “We have great, proactive programming strength in India, better than anywhere else in the world. People should combine entertainment industry skills and programming skills to develop revolutionary and

Things to be kept in mind while developing a mobile game

1. Not all devices are the same. Think about device compatibility. Don’t do something overwhelmingly stupid that forces the user to uninstall your masterpiece.
2. Resources are very important. Do not drain the resources of the device on which the user has allowed your game to reside. You do that once, and there is no way you can get your game installed on the same device again.
3. The game should not prevent users from doing their routine work. For example, when the user is in between a level, and wants to make a call, that should be possible—without the call getting cut or the player having to go back to start the game from the base level. If that happens a couple of times, the game will get uninstalled.
4. There are millions of apps and a lot of other games, so do your best to get your user’s attention at the first shot.
5. Think about your user base and design the game accordingly. For instance, if it is a game for nursery school kids, the visuals have to suit them. Similarly, the theme has to be different for teens, adults, office goers, etc.
6. Don’t irritate users. Pop-ups every minute or so to ask for feedback, asking users to buy something, asking them to share, etc, will turn off users. The best thing is to think of yourself playing the game developed by some other person. What would you not like? There is a strong possibility that your users too will not like the same thing.
7. A challenge is very important. A game developer has to consider this factor. A game with an adequate level of challenge that allows friends to compete with each other can become a hit.

fresh games. Investments and forecasts should be based on ground-level realities, and not just on the company’s turnover or on market-based analysis. There needs to be support for developing such great games in terms of a creative environment, sustainable business strategies with low/medium costs of production using HTML5 kind of technologies and strong marketing skills. Of course, government support for the industry would be great, if possible. Even without all these, a powerful game can be developed by Indian programmers but a lot of self-discipline, financial freedom, a great amount of market analysis and experience are needed,” says Pradeep.

According to Pradeep, any kind of failure could land the developer in trouble, preventing one from concentrating on any level of creative development. So, entrepreneurs should study the ground realities well before taking any adventurous steps in games development on their own; but if the proper precautions are taken—yes, great games can be developed by solo developers from India.

Even small and brain-teasing games are widely